

AI & Tech News Digest - 2026-09-28

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Source: <https://techcrunch.com/category/artificial-intelligence/>

1. Anthropic, Gamma, and Clay share what happens when enterprises actually deploy AI at TechCrunch Disrupt 2026

Leaders from three AI companies will discuss real-world lessons from enterprise AI rollouts at Disrupt 2026.

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/09/28/anthropic-gamma-and-clay-share-what-happens-when-enterprises-actually-deploy-ai-at-techcrunch-disrupt-2026/>

2. After a deepfake voice fooled her grandfather, this founder sprang into action

A personal encounter with a voice-cloning scam led a founder to build a startup fighting deepfake fraud.

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/09/28/after-a-deepfake-voice-fooled-her-grandfather-this-founder-sprang-into-action/>

3. Next five VCs judging Startup Battlefield 200 contenders at TechCrunch Disrupt 2026

TechCrunch named more venture investors who will judge startups competing in its Battlefield contest.

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/09/28/next-five-vcs-judging-startup-battlefield-200-contenders-at-techcrunch-disrupt-2026/>

4. Modulate raises \$25M for its voice models and analysis suite

Voice AI company Modulate secured \$25M in new funding for its voice models and analysis tools.

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/09/28/modulate-raises-25m-for-its-voice-models-and-analysis-suite/>

5. Insurtech Outmarket raises \$34.5M just months after prior round

Insurance-tech startup Outmarket raised \$34.5M soon after its last round, signaling strong investor appetite.

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/09/28/insuretech-outmarket-raises-34-5m-just-months-after-prior-round/>

6. Viral AI agent Instinct raises \$1B Series C at a \$10B valuation

AI agent startup Instinct hit a \$10B valuation with a \$1B raise, showing how hot the agent market is.

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/09/28/viral-ai-agent-instinct-raises-1b-series-c-at-a-10b-valuation/>

7. Anthropic's CEO is about to have dinner with President Trump

Anthropic's Dario Amodei is set to meet President Trump, a notable moment for AI-industry relations with the White House.

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/09/27/anthropics-ceo-is-about-to-have-dinner-with-president-trump/>

8. Can Muse overcome Meta's trust issues?

An analysis of whether Meta's Muse product can win users despite lingering skepticism about Meta.

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/09/27/can-muse-overcome-metas-trust-issues/>

9. Anthropic's Dario Amodei gets the SNL treatment

Saturday Night Live parodied Anthropic's CEO, a sign of how mainstream AI leaders have become.

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/09/27/anthropics-dario-amodei-gets-the-snl-treatment/>

10. Google tests buying from Walmart-owned Flipkart through Gemini and AI Mode in India

Google is piloting in-chat shopping from Flipkart via Gemini and AI Mode, pushing AI deeper into e-commerce.

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/09/26/google-tests-buying-from-walmart-owned-flipkart-through-gemini-and-ai-mode-in-india/>

11. Insurers claim AI is already increasing healthcare costs

Health insurers say AI adoption is pushing healthcare costs up rather than down.

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/09/26/insurers-claim-ai-is-already-increasing-healthcare-costs/>

12. I created an interactive digital avatar of myself - and you can talk to it

A TechCrunch writer built a conversational AI avatar of themselves, testing how far digital clones have come.

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/09/26/i-created-an-interactive-digital-avatar-of-myself-and-you-can-talk-to-it/>

13. At Meta Connect, the company's smart glasses were everywhere

Meta leaned heavily on smart glasses at its Connect event, underscoring its bet on AI wearables.

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/09/25/at-meta-connect-the-companys-smart-glasses-were-everywhere/>

14. Crusoe abandons \$1.25B plan to use Boom turbines at AI data centers

Crusoe dropped a \$1.25B plan to power AI data centers with Boom turbines, highlighting AI's energy challenges.

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/09/25/crusoe-abandons-1-25b-plan-to-use-boom-turbines-at-ai-data-centers/>

15. Unsecured OpenAI agents posted 53 user images on the internet without the lab's knowledge

Unsecured OpenAI agents exposed 53 user images publicly, raising security concerns about autonomous agents.

<https://techcrunch.com/2026/09/25/unsecured-openai-agents-posted-53-user-images-on-the-internet-without-the-labs-knowledge/>

Top themes today: AI agents (funding & security), Anthropic in the spotlight, AI startup funding, Meta's Muse & smart glasses